

AGENDA: WEEK THREE
Revised 4/25
Welcome Back to the 4th Step Workshop

Congratulations! Good job for making the decision to take on your own life!

1. Please join us in the Serenity Prayer

2. Introductions all around

3. Housekeeping Items...

- If the door is closed before 7 pm, we are doing some prep work
- Please silence your cell phone
- Different 12 step groups are represented here tonight, so please be considerate
- Speak loudly and clearly so all can hear what you have to share
- Raise your hand if you can't hear others or the Facilitators
- Circulate attendance sheet (for our use)
- We pass the basket to help cover cost for workshop space rental, materials, etc
- Suggested donation is \$20 for entire workshop (only if able)
- Bathrooms are down the hall all the way on your right

4. Discussion Topics

- **How did your week go?**
- **Were there any problems with column three?**
- **Was The Glossary helpful?**
- **Are you making time to do this?**
- **How are your disciplines working?**
- **Did anyone have trouble finishing the assignment? Emphasize importance to get caught up**
- **Did anyone see that it was parts of self that were affected in column 3, not what they did in column 2, or who did it in column 1 that caused the resentment? REPEAT**

5. A reading from the Big Book

"We turned back to the list, for it held the key to the future. We were prepared to look at it from an entirely different angle. We began to see that the world and its people really dominated us. In the state, the wrong-doing of others, fancied or real, had power to actually kill. How could we escape? We saw that these resentments must be mastered, but how? We could not wish them away any more than alcohol.

This was our course: We realized that the people who wronged us were perhaps spiritually sick. Though we did not like their symptoms and the way these disturbed us, they, like ourselves, were sick too. We asked God to help us show them the same

tolerance, pity, and patience that we would cheerfully grant a sick friend. When a person offended we said to ourselves, “This is a sick man. How can I be helpful to him? God save me from being angry. Thy will be done.”

We avoid retaliation or argument. We wouldn’t treat sick people that way. If we do, we destroy our chance of being helpful. We cannot be helpful to all people, but at least God will show us how to take a kindly and tolerant view of each and every one.

Referring to our list again. Putting out of our minds the wrongs others had done, we resolutely looked for our own mistakes. Where had we been selfish, dishonest, self-seeking and frightened? Though a situation had not been entirely our fault, we tried to disregard the other person involved entirely. Where were we to blame? The inventory was ours, not the other man’s. When we saw our faults we listed them. We placed them before us in black and white. We admitted our wrongs honestly and were willing to set these matters straight.” (Page 66, paragraph 3 through page 67, paragraph 2)

6. Explain Column 4 **What is our part?**

- Page 2 of Glossary – Column 4
- Go over all parts of the main definition
- Work our examples of Column 4 on the Board
- Top to bottom, one column at a time & then questions
- Any final questions about column 4 before we move on?

7. **First half of this week’s assignment is column 4 of the Resentments Sheet.**

Introduction to FEARS sheet

8. Big Book Reading (**Fears**) (Page 67, paragraph 3 through Page 68, paragraph 3)

“Notice that the word “fear” is bracketed alongside the difficulties with Mr. Brown, Mrs. Jones, the employer, and the wife. This short word somehow touches about every aspect of our lives. It was an evil and corroding thread; the fabric of our existence was shot through with it. It set in motion trains of circumstances which brought us misfortune we felt we didn’t deserve. But did not we, ourselves, set the ball rolling? Sometimes we think fear ought to be classified with stealing. It seems to cause more trouble.

We reviewed our fears thoroughly. We put them on paper, even though we had no resentment in connection with them. We asked ourselves why we had them. Wasn’t it because self-reliance failed us? Self-reliance was good as far as it went, but it didn’t go far enough. Some of us once had great self-confidence, but it didn’t fully solve the fear problem, or any other. When it made us cocky, it was worse.

Perhaps there is a better way - we think so. For we are now on a different basis; the basis of trusting and relying upon God. We trust infinite God rather than our finite selves. We are in the world to play the role He assigns. Just to the extent that we do as we think He would have us, and humbly rely on Him, does He enable us to match calamity with serenity.

We never apologize to anyone for depending upon our creator. We can laugh at those who think spirituality is the way of weakness. Paradoxically, it is the way of strength. The verdict of the ages is that faith means courage. All men of faith have courage. They trust their God. We never apologize for God. Instead we let Him remove our fear and direct our attention to what He would have us be. At once, we commence to outgrow fear.”

9. Read the definition of **Fears** from The Glossary

- Ask Participants to get out The Review of Fears worksheet
- Also to look at the Partial Fear list for ideas
- Complete Columns 1 & 2 of Fears worksheet for next week

10. Talk about and give dates for 5th Step Appointment.

- Thursday _____ through Monday _____
- Talk about considerations for:
 - Scheduling 5th Steps
 - Receiving 5th Steps

11. Questions

12. Assignment Review

- Column 4 of Resentments TOP TO BOTTOM
- Column 1 & 2 of FEARS TOP TO BOTTOM
- Set appointment for 5th Step
- Use Glossary
- Call your Sponsor
- Use the Phone list and call/text Facilitators
- **“Please join us in the Serenity Prayer”**